

STARTUP VALIDATION REPORT

VC / Consulting-Style Validation Framework

Prepared for: **[Founder / Startup Name]**

Market: **[Target Country / Region]**

Date: **22 August 2026**

Important Note

This is a professional PDF-ready validation template. Startup-specific conclusions, market figures, competitor findings, and scores should be completed after the founder answers the seven discovery questions and provides any existing validation evidence.

1. Executive Summary

[Summarize the startup, problem, customer, market opportunity, validation evidence, and preliminary investment thesis here.]

Overall Opportunity Score: [X/10]

2. Problem Validation

Problem Statement

[Describe the core customer problem and why it is painful, frequent, expensive, risky, or time-consuming.]

Validation Evidence

- [Customer interviews / survey evidence]
- [Existing users or waitlist]
- [Observed behavior or current alternatives]
- [Willingness-to-pay evidence]

Problem Severity Score: [X/10]

3. Founder-Market Fit

Founder-Market Fit Score: [X/10]

Dimension	Score	Assessment
Domain knowledge	[X/10]	[Evidence]
Technical capability	[X/10]	[Evidence]
Customer access	[X/10]	[Evidence]
Personal insight	[X/10]	[Evidence]
Execution ability	[X/10]	[Evidence]

4. TAM / SAM / SOM Analysis

Market	Estimated Size	Calculation / Assumption
TAM	[Amount]	[Method]
SAM	[Amount]	[Method]
SOM	[Amount]	[Method]

Market-sizing figures should distinguish verified market data from estimates and assumptions. Avoid false precision where reliable data is unavailable.

5. Competitor Analysis

Competitor	Strengths	Weaknesses	Pricing	Opportunity
[Competitor 1]	[Strengths]	[Weaknesses]	[Price]	[Gap]

Competitor	Strengths	Weaknesses	Pricing	Opportunity
[Competitor 2]	[Strengths]	[Weaknesses]	[Price]	[Gap]
[Competitor 3]	[Strengths]	[Weaknesses]	[Price]	[Gap]
[Substitute]	[Strengths]	[Weaknesses]	[Cost]	[Gap]

6. Market Gap Analysis

- [Unserved customer segment]
- [Missing feature / workflow]
- [Pricing or accessibility gap]
- [Distribution or trust gap]

Differentiation Thesis: [Explain why customers would choose this solution over existing alternatives.]

7. Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Attribute	Definition
Customer type	[B2B / B2C / B2B2C]
Industry	[Industry]
Company / customer size	[Size]
Location	[Location]
Budget	[Budget]
Primary pain	[Pain]
Buying motivation	[Motivation]

8. Buyer Persona

[Persona name, role, goals, challenges, decision criteria, buying behavior, and information sources.]

9. Customer Pain Points

Pain Point	Severity	Frequency	Willingness to Pay
[Pain 1]	High	High	High
[Pain 2]	Medium	High	Medium
[Pain 3]	High	Medium	High

10. Buying Triggers & Objections

Buying Triggers

- [Trigger 1]

- [Trigger 2]
- [Trigger 3]

Objections

- [Objection 1]
- [Objection 2]
- [Objection 3]

11. Customer Journey

Awareness → Discovery → Evaluation → Trial/Demo → Purchase → Onboarding → Successful Outcome → Retention → Referral

[Describe the key conversion points and customer actions at each stage.]

12. Risk Assessment

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Market risk	Medium	High	[Action]
Competition risk	High	High	[Action]
Product risk	Medium	High	[Action]
Customer acquisition	High	High	[Action]
Pricing risk	Medium	Medium	[Action]
Execution risk	Medium	High	[Action]

13. Pivot Opportunities

- [Pivot toward a different customer segment]
- [Pivot toward a different use case]
- [Pivot business model / pricing / distribution]

14. Go / No-Go Recommendation

Recommendation: **[GO / CONDITIONAL GO / NO-GO]**

[Explain the recommendation using evidence from problem severity, customer demand, market size, competition, and execution risk.]

15. 30-Day Action Plan

Period	Primary Objective	Actions	Success Metric
Days 1–7	Customer discovery	10–20 interviews; identify pain points	[Metric]
Days 8–14	Problem validation	Landing page; messaging; waitlist	[Metric]
Days 15–21	MVP validation	Prototype; early users; feedback	[Metric]

Period	Primary Objective	Actions	Success Metric
Days 22–30	Business validation	Pricing; first paying users	[Metric]

16. Final Investment / Validation Thesis

[State the strongest reason to continue, the biggest unresolved assumption, and the single experiment that would most increase confidence in the startup.]

END OF REPORT